

Module 13: Cities, Communities, and Integration

Service Learning Project

Mapping Welcome: A Community Asset Map for Newcomer Integration

Overview

Partner with a settlement house, city newcomer office, or integration program to build a neighborhood asset map of services and community resources for newly arrived residents — and identify one gap worth acting on.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe integration challenges in a real neighborhood (UG 1)
- Identify support systems and services (UG 2)
- Explain the role of communities and community-led solutions (UG 3)
- Recognize policy impacts at street level (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Settlement houses and integration service providers
- City/county offices of new Americans
- Refugee-led and immigrant-led community organizations
- Housing and tenant support organizations in arrival neighborhoods

Project steps

1. Scope the map with the partner: which neighborhood, which newcomer populations, which service domains (housing, ESL, health, legal, childcare, faith, transit).
2. Field-verify: visit or contact services; record languages available, eligibility, hours, and access barriers.
3. Include community-led assets — mutual aid, congregations, informal networks — not just formal agencies.
4. Build the map in the partner's preferred format (printable, digital, multilingual).
5. Identify one significant service gap and draft a short intervention idea with the partner's input.
6. Present the map and gap analysis to partner staff.

Deliverables

- Community asset map (partner keeps, partner format)
- Gap analysis and intervention brief (2 pages)
- Reflection on community-led vs. top-down integration (2 pages)

Time commitment

15–18 hours.

Ethics requirements

Verify information before publishing; never list informal supports that communities prefer to keep unlisted.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Completeness and field verification of the map 30%	The deliverable is excellent: completeness and field verification of the map is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: completeness and field verification of the map is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: completeness and field verification of the map is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: completeness and field verification of the map is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.
Inclusion of community-led assets 20%	Collaboration is genuinely shared: inclusion of community-led assets is fully realized — partner and community voices shaped key decisions, their priorities are visible in the result, and their contribution is credited.	Collaboration is real: inclusion of community-led assets is achieved — the partner reviewed and influenced the work, though some decisions stayed one-sided.	Collaboration is thin: inclusion of community-led assets is claimed more than practiced; the partner was consulted late or superficially, and the result reflects the student's assumptions.	Collaboration is absent: inclusion of community-led assets did not occur; the work was done about or for the community rather than with it.
Quality of gap analysis and intervention idea 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: quality of gap analysis and intervention idea goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: quality of gap analysis and intervention idea is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: quality of gap analysis and intervention idea is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: quality of gap analysis and intervention idea is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Reflection quality 20%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: reflection quality shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: reflection quality shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: reflection quality is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: reflection quality shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.